This means that while Russia will derive massive economic benefits from the deal, it will in turn offer Zimbabwe weapons of repression. Zimbabwe has not had war with its neighbours since independence in 1980, except for a brief intervention to assist the Mozambican government against Renamo rebels in the late 1980s. On the contrary, Zimbabwe is having serious internal threats to human security in the form of hunger, disease, climate change and joblessness. These challenges cannot be defeated by military hardware but rather by sound, consistent and people-centred policies. Instead of allowing Zimbabwe's mineral wealth to contribute to economic recovery for the overall welfare of its people, Russia is ensuring the country remains poor and oppressed by strengthening the military. The Darwendale platinum deposit has been estimated at 40 million ounces of Platinum Group Metals and is among the world's largest PGM deposits.

Another Russian company, DTZ-OZGEO (Private) Limited, is jointly owned by the Development Trust of Zimbabwe (DTZ) and a Russian company, Econedra Limited. This company is involved in gold and diamond mining in Penhalonga and Chimanimani respectively and holds several claims all over Zimbabwe in places such as Shurugwi and the Bvumba. However, DTZ-OZGEO has performed poorly in terms of transparency, environmental management and corporate social responsibility. Mugabe expressed disappointment with the secretive nature of DTZ-OZGEO operations during the ZANU-PF People's Conference held in Mutare in December 2010 and during a meeting with traditional chiefs in Manicaland in 2011. As he bitterly put it,

> The company [Development Trust of Zimbabwe], having joined hands with the Russians, approached us saying they wanted to mine gold in Mutare and we gave them the go-ahead. They later moved to Chimanimani. We were told that DTZ and their Russian counterparts are mining gold in Chimanimani and now it is diamonds. We have not realised any real revenue coming from them and they are saying they are having some difficulties. I talked to some of the directors during our December People's Conference here in Mutare and I told them that they were remaining too much in isolation and why don't they become transparent. We will pursue the matter because we want to know what they are doing. We want our people, especially our children, to benefit through this company.

However, three years later DTZ-OZGEO continues with its opaque operations amidst massive environmental degradation. Penhalonga residents are up in arms with the company for destroying the course of the Mutare River. Since